

Hilly Half Marathon Elite Plan (Oct 15, 2025 → Mar 15, 2026)

(AM/PM Splits • Compact Single-Column • Styled after your template)

Goal: Half Marathon (~1000 m elevation gain) • Coach style: strict, data-driven, injury-aware

Assumptions & Safety Notes

- Age 28; prior knee and lumbar disc injury — all hard sessions are conditional on pain-free status.
- Race day: Sun Mar 15, 2026. Plan spans 22 weeks from Oct 15, 2025.
- Treadmill hill tempo cap: 5–8% for running; 8–12% for short power-hike blocks only.
- No two hard runs back-to-back. Heavy posterior-chain strength never the day before intervals or long run.
- Sharp pain or radiating symptoms → stop session, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.
- Deload every 4th week (~30–40% volume reduction) while keeping one light quality touch.

Heart Rate Zones (Karvonen Method)

- Inputs: Max HR = 192 bpm (220 – age), Resting HR = 55 bpm, HRR = 137 bpm.
- Zone 1 (Recovery, 50–60% HRR): 124–137 bpm — easy walks, recovery runs.
- Zone 2 (Aerobic, 60–70% HRR): 137–151 bpm — easy/long runs.
- Zone 3 (Tempo, 70–80% HRR): 151–165 bpm — tempo sessions (comfortably hard).
- Zone 4 (Threshold, 80–90% HRR): 165–179 bpm — intervals, hill repeats.
- Zone 5 (VO₂max, 90–100% HRR): 179–192 bpm — short sprints only.

Key Training Paces

- Easy/Long-run pace (start→end): about 7:33/km–8:18/km drifting toward 7:13/km–8:03/km as durability improves.
- Tempo pace (continuous): roughly 6:06/km–6:21/km improving toward 5:41/km–6:01/km.
- Intervals (flat): 5:21/km–5:33/km improving toward 5:01/km–5:18/km.
- Hill repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 5:30/km–6:06/km improving toward 5:10/km–5:51/km.

Fueling & Hydration (Simple Rules)

- AM runs ≤60 min: water; optional coffee/tea if tolerated.
- Long runs >12 km: small carb 10–15 min pre; 30–60 g carbs/hour during; electrolytes on hot days.
- Post-run (≤45 min): 20–30 g protein + 1–1.2 g/kg carbs; keep meals simple and familiar.

Daily Mobility Sequence (10–15 min)

- Foam roll 1 min each: calves, hamstrings, quads, IT band, glutes.
- 90/90 hips 2×8/side; Cat-Cow 2×10 slow; Ankle circles 10 each direction.
- Glute bridge with march 2×10/side; World's Greatest Stretch 2×5/side; Bretzel 30s/side.

Week 1: Mon Oct 13, 2025 to Sun Oct 19, 2025 — Phase: Base

• Monday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:33/km–8:18/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:21/km–5:33/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 7 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:33/km–8:18/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 6:06/km–6:21/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 5 km Easy @ 7:33/km–8:18/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 12 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:33/km–8:09/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Establish frequency and easy effort; prioritize posture and cadence.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 2: Mon Oct 20, 2025 to Sun Oct 26, 2025 — Phase: Base

• Monday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:32/km–8:17/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:29/km–6:05/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 7 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:32/km–8:17/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 6:05/km–6:20/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 5 km Easy @ 7:32/km–8:17/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 14 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:32/km–8:09/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Introduce short hills and tempo; no grinding or forced paces.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 3: Mon Oct 27, 2025 to Sun Nov 02, 2025 — Phase: Base

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:31/km–8:17/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:19/km–5:32/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 7 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:31/km–8:17/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 6:04/km–6:19/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 5 km Easy @ 7:31/km–8:17/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 16 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:32/km–8:08/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Slight volume nudge; practice fueling on the long run.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 4: Mon Nov 03, 2025 to Sun Nov 09, 2025 — Phase: Base

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:30/km–8:16/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:27/km–6:04/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 7 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:30/km–8:16/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 6:02/km–6:18/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 5 km Easy @ 7:30/km–8:16/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 12 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:31/km–8:08/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Deload: cut volume ~30%; keep one short quality touch.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 5: Mon Nov 10, 2025 to Sun Nov 16, 2025 — Phase: Aerobic Strength

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:29/km–8:15/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:17/km–5:30/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:29/km–8:15/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 6:01/km–6:17/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 5 km Easy @ 7:29/km–8:15/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 17 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:30/km–8:07/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Two hill stimuli this week; control descents on outdoor slope.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 6: Mon Nov 17, 2025 to Sun Nov 23, 2025 — Phase: Aerobic Strength

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:28/km–8:14/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:25/km–6:02/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:28/km–8:14/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 6:00/km–6:16/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 5 km Easy @ 7:28/km–8:14/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 18 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:29/km–8:07/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Tempo durability focus; settle into effort without forcing pace.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 7: Mon Nov 24, 2025 to Sun Nov 30, 2025 — Phase: Aerobic Strength

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:27/km–8:14/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:15/km–5:29/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:27/km–8:14/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 5:59/km–6:15/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:27/km–8:14/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 19 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:29/km–8:06/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Progressive long run; practice gels every ~45–50 min.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 8: Mon Dec 01, 2025 to Sun Dec 07, 2025 — Phase: Aerobic Strength

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:26/km–8:13/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:23/km–6:01/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:26/km–8:13/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 5:58/km–6:14/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:26/km–8:13/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 14 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:28/km–8:06/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Deload: reduce reps/sets; back and knee should feel fresh.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 9: Mon Dec 08, 2025 to Sun Dec 14, 2025 — Phase: Hill Power

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:25/km–8:12/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:13/km–5:27/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:25/km–8:12/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 5:56/km–6:13/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:25/km–8:12/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 20 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:27/km–8:05/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Power-hike blocks on treadmill 8–10% to build economy safely.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 10: Mon Dec 15, 2025 to Sun Dec 21, 2025 — Phase: Hill Power

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:24/km–8:12/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:21/km–5:60/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:24/km–8:12/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 5:55/km–6:12/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:24/km–8:12/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 21 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:27/km–8:05/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Long hill tempo steady pressure; outdoor hill reps stay snappy.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 11: Mon Dec 22, 2025 to Sun Dec 28, 2025 — Phase: Hill Power

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:23/km–8:11/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:11/km–5:26/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:23/km–8:11/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 5:54/km–6:11/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:23/km–8:11/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 22 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:26/km–8:04/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Back-to-back load appears; keep day-after easy and short if needed.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 12: Mon Dec 29, 2025 to Sun Jan 04, 2026 — Phase: Hill Power

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:23/km–8:10/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:20/km–5:58/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:23/km–8:10/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 5:53/km–6:11/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:23/km–8:10/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 16 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:25/km–8:04/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Deload before next peak; sleep is the multiplier.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 13: Mon Jan 05, 2026 to Sun Jan 11, 2026 — Phase: Peak Simulation

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:22/km–8:09/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:10/km–5:24/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:22/km–8:09/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 5:52/km–6:10/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:22/km–8:09/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 22 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:24/km–8:03/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Race-specific simulation starts; dial fueling and shoe choice.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 14: Mon Jan 12, 2026 to Sun Jan 18, 2026 — Phase: Peak Simulation

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:21/km–8:09/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:18/km–5:57/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:21/km–8:09/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 5:51/km–6:09/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:21/km–8:09/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 23 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:24/km–8:03/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Most specific climbing week; monitor next-morning stiffness.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 15: Mon Jan 19, 2026 to Sun Jan 25, 2026 — Phase: Peak Simulation

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:20/km–8:08/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:08/km–5:23/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:20/km–8:08/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 5:49/km–6:08/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:20/km–8:08/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 24 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:23/km–8:02/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Final big long run; ego in check, technique first.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 16: Mon Jan 26, 2026 to Sun Feb 01, 2026 — Phase: Peak Simulation

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:19/km–8:07/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:16/km–5:55/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:19/km–8:07/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 5:48/km–6:07/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:19/km–8:07/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 20 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:22/km–8:02/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

[Coach Notes: Consolidate with slight volume drop; one controlled tempo.](#)

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 17: Mon Feb 02, 2026 to Sun Feb 08, 2026 — Phase: Peak Simulation

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:18/km–8:07/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:06/km–5:22/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:18/km–8:07/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 5:47/km–6:06/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:18/km–8:07/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 24 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:22/km–8:01/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Consolidate with slight volume drop; one controlled tempo.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 18: Mon Feb 09, 2026 to Sun Feb 15, 2026 — Phase: Peak Simulation

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:17/km–8:06/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:14/km–5:54/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:17/km–8:06/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 5:46/km–6:05/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:17/km–8:06/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 25 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:21/km–8:01/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Consolidate with slight volume drop; one controlled tempo.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 19: Mon Feb 16, 2026 to Sun Feb 22, 2026 — Phase: Peak Simulation

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:16/km–8:05/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:04/km–5:20/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:16/km–8:05/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 5:45/km–6:04/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:16/km–8:05/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 22 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:20/km–8:00/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Consolidate with slight volume drop; one controlled tempo.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 20: Mon Feb 23, 2026 to Sun Mar 01, 2026 — Phase: Peak Simulation

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:15/km–8:04/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:12/km–5:52/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:15/km–8:04/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 5:43/km–6:03/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:15/km–8:04/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 18 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:19/km–7:60/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Consolidate with slight volume drop; one controlled tempo.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 21: Mon Mar 02, 2026 to Sun Mar 08, 2026 — Phase: Taper

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:14/km–8:04/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 7 km total — Intervals (flat): 6–8 × 400–600 m @ 5:02/km–5:19/km • RPE 7–8 • equal jog rec; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:14/km–8:04/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 7 km total — Tempo: 20–30 min continuous @ 5:42/km–6:02/km • RPE 6–7 • smooth & even; WU/CD included.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:14/km–8:04/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Hyrox-style, 4 rds) — Walking Lunges 20 steps; Push-ups 12–15; Goblet Squat 12; Burpees 8–10; Row/Ski 400m; 60–75s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 16 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:19/km–7:59/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Reduce volume ~40–50%; one short tempo and a few strides.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Week 22: Mon Mar 09, 2026 to Sun Mar 15, 2026 — Phase: Taper

• Monday

AM: 7 km Easy @ 7:13/km–8:03/km • RPE 3–4. Cadence & posture; 1 km walk/jog warm-up.

PM: Stability Strength — Step-ups 3×10/leg; Glute Bridge 3×15; Bird-dog 3×10/side; Side Plank 3×30–45s; Calf Raises 3×20; McGill Curl-up 3×8/side.

• Tuesday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Repeats (outdoor 1 km slope): 6–8 × 400–600 m climbs @ 5:10/km–5:51/km • RPE 7–8 • jog/walk down; control descent.

PM: Mobility + Core (20–25 min): Hip flexor, hamstring floss, T-spine; Dead bug 3×10; Side bridge 3×30–45s.

• Wednesday

AM: 8 km Easy + 4×20 s strides @ 7:13/km–8:03/km • RPE 3–4 • strides relaxed, not sprints.

PM: Posterior Chain — Barbell RDL 3×8–10 (light–moderate); Goblet Squat 3×10–12; KB/DB Swing 3×12–15 (pain-free); Pallof Press 3×10/side; Farmer Carry 3×40–60m.

• Thursday

AM: 6.5 km total — Hill Tempo (treadmill 5–7%): 15–25 min @ 5:41/km–6:01/km • RPE 6–7 • posture tall, no hip hinge.

PM: Mobility Flow (20 min): Hips, calves, glutes; Foam roll 5–8 min.

• Friday

AM: 6 km Easy @ 7:13/km–8:03/km • RPE 3–4 • keep truly easy to absorb quality.

PM: PM: Functional (Power/Grip, 4 rds) — DB Thruster 10; KB Swing 15; Farmer Carry 60–80m; Wall Balls 15–20 (or DB thruster); 60–90s rest.

• Saturday

AM: 12 km Long Run (rolling hills) @ 7:18/km–7:59/km • RPE 3–4 • Fuel: 30–60 g carbs/hr + fluids. Last 2–3 km steady, not hard (except deload weeks).

PM: Mobility/Stretch 10–15 min; optional easy swim 400–800 m.

• Sunday

AM: Swim 1.0–1.5 km easy technique OR Rest/20–30 min walk • Recovery focus.

Coach Notes: Race week: sharpen, don't chase fitness; rehearse elevations.

Red Flags: Sharp knee/back pain, radiating symptoms, or morning stiffness >30 min → stop intensity, substitute swim/walk, reassess next day.

Race-Week Tips & Pacing

- Reduce weekly volume by ~40–50%; keep one 10–15 min tempo early and 4–6 relaxed strides midweek.
- Treadmill elevation rehearsal midweek: 10–12 min at 5–7% steady.

- Night before: simple dinner; morning of: light carbs + electrolytes.
- On course: power-hike steeper ramps if HR surges; open stride gently on flats; protect knees on descents.

Race Pacing Framework (Hilly HM $\approx$ 1000 m gain): Start controlled for 3–4 km, climb at RPE 6–7 (let pace slow), settle near tempo on rolling sections, and press a steady finish over the final 3–4 km. Goal: strong, pain-free finish (~2:45–3:00).